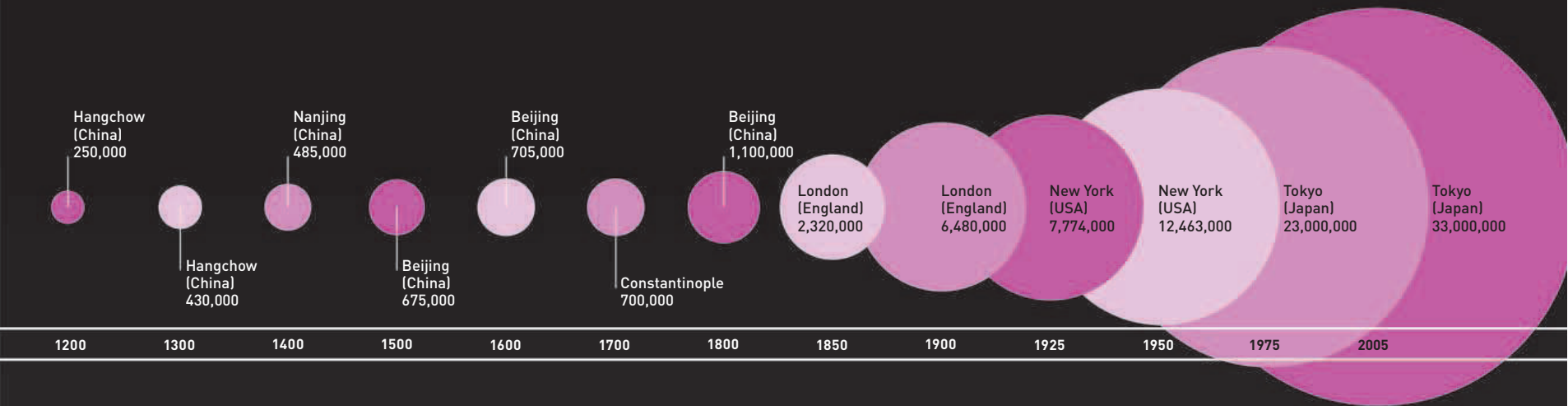
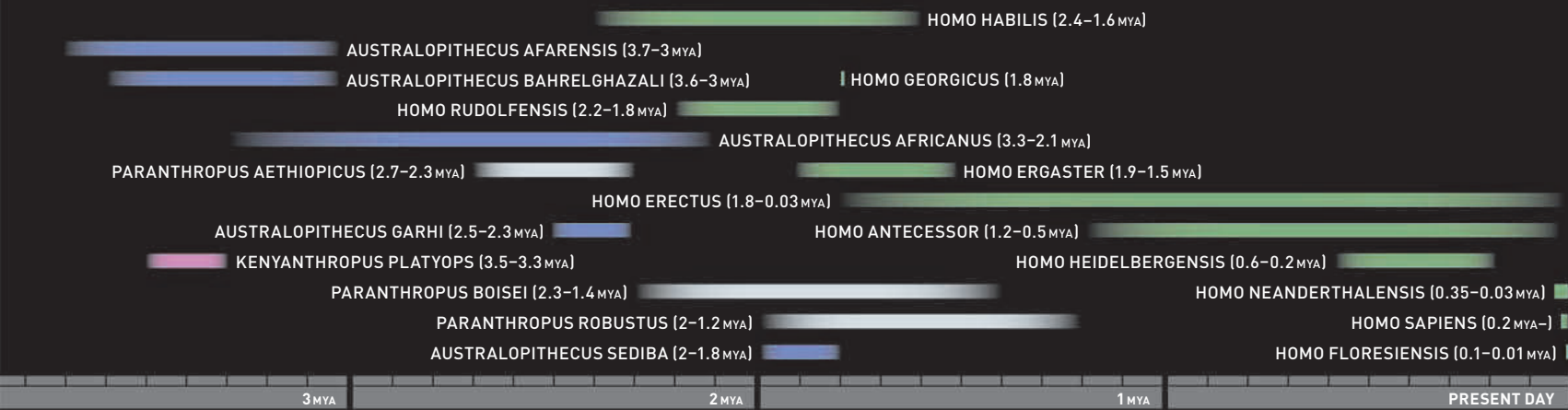
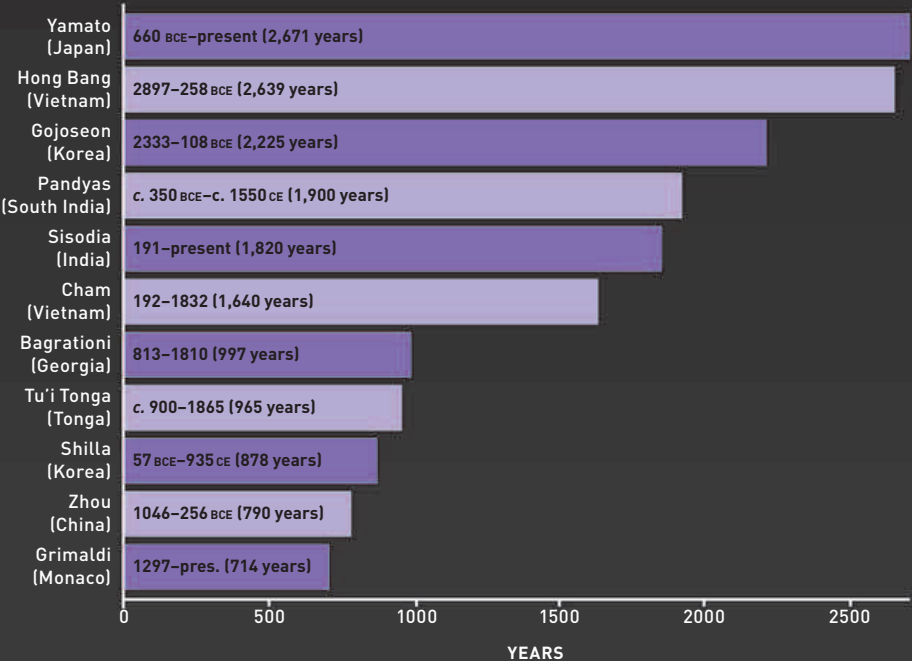




LONGEST-REIGNING DYNASTIES

Although the life-span of a ruling dynasty has seldom been more than a few hundred years, in exceptional cases a ruling house has held power for more than a thousand, while in Japan the Yamato dynasty has survived for more than 2,500 and still rules today.



LONGEST-REIGNING MONARCHS

Some monarchs have had astonishingly long reigns. Although in general this meant they came to the throne as small children and initially exercised little power, those who enjoyed a long reign often brought a period of power and prosperity to their country.

